



INSTALLATION INSTRUCTIONS

Power Glove Vision Installation Guide

Install, pair, and play with the PowerGlove Vision Controller and RetroPie.

2026 EDITION / IAIN BENNETT / MIT LICENSE

Install PowerGlove Vision with one script on the **PowerGlove Vision Controller (Arduino UNO Q)** and one on RetroPie. The scripts prepare the software and startup helpers; you finish by pairing the devices, positioning the camera, and testing a game.

Choose **Setup -> Matrix attract mode** to keep the idle animation On, Dim it, or turn it Off except for faint connection pixels. This does not change game displays, T, L, or gesture recognition. The setting saves without a tracker restart.

For an existing installation, this update changes controller transport on both computers. Stop controller output, update both to matching software, then start and test input. Mixed old/new versions do not deliver input with the default settings. See [signed controller transport and upgrades](#) for staged upgrades and rollback.

Try release candidate v0.4.0-rc.1

Release candidate **v0.4.0-rc.1** is intended for users who want to try the new low-latency camera and native movement work before the final release. Close games and stop controller output, then run the matching command on each device. These explicit commands select the prerelease; the normal commands later in this guide continue to select the latest stable release.

On the PowerGlove Vision Controller:

```
SH
curl -fLO \
  https://github.com/mathan416/PowerGlove-Vision/releases/download/v0.4.0-rc.1/install-uno-q.sh \
  && bash install-uno-q.sh --development v0.4.0-rc.1
```

On RetroPie:

```
SH
curl -fLO \
  https://github.com/mathan416/PowerGlove-Vision/releases/download/v0.4.0-rc.1/install-retropie.sh \
  && bash install-retropie.sh --development v0.4.0-rc.1
```

Verify both report **v0.4.0-rc.1**, then follow the pairing/first-game checks below. Existing hand settings and pairing files are preserved. The Controller installer also updates the matrix firmware. Review [coordinated transport upgrades and rollback](#) before replacing an older installation.

1. Prepare your devices

You need a provisioned PowerGlove Vision Controller, a working RetroPie system, a UVC USB camera, a powered USB hub, and a physical controller for RetroArch setup. Put both devices on the same trusted local network with internet access. Supply your own games; no ROMs or BIOS files are included.

For a new Controller, use Arduino App Lab to complete board setup and networking. Record both devices' hostnames. Connect the camera through the powered hub. You do not need to import PowerGlove Vision through App Lab or build a ZIP on your computer. The installer builds and uploads the Arduino sketch for you.

Open a terminal on each device, either locally or over SSH. For the Controller:

```
SH
ssh arduino@UNO-Q-NAME.local
```

Replace the example hostnames with your actual names. Use your normal account; the scripts request your sudo password when administrator access is needed. They do not store it. Close games before installing. Leave the devices powered and connected while installation runs; first setup can take several minutes.

The commands below automatically select the latest published stable release from GitHub. You do not need to enter a release tag or set shell variables. Run both installers during the same setup session and compare the reported release names; if a new release appeared between runs, rerun the older installation. Development prereleases are available separately in the technical reference. The latest release must include the installer assets before these commands work.

2. Run the PowerGlove Vision Controller installer

Run this single line in the Controller terminal:

```
SH
curl -fLO \
  https://github.com/mathan416/PowerGlove-Vision/releases/latest/download/install-uno-q.sh \
  && bash install-uno-q.sh
```

The script verifies its download, installs the app and sketch, and configures automatic startup. It includes the early-start hourglass helper and the Shutdown button's system helper. No separate helper commands are needed. Existing pairing, calibration, and personal tuning are preserved when updating. The supplied `config/profiles.json` baseline is backed up and replaced so current shared recognition defaults take effect. That baseline includes the tested movement hysteresis, native full-field mapping, and low-lag stabilization. The installer does not copy a maintainer's neutral-hand coordinates: those measurements depend on each camera, distance, and playing position.

If the script reports a failure, stop and follow its message. If `curl` is missing, install it with `sudo apt-get install curl ca-certificates`, then retry. The installer checks compatibility before changing the application.

Checkpoint: Open <http://UNO-Q-NAME.local:8088/dashboard> in your browser. Dashboard should load. With gestures off, a closed camera is normal. Open **Play** or **Glove Academy** to check that your camera view and whole hand appear, then return to Dashboard with controller transmission stopped.

New installations keep **Compatible - OpenCV** and **Automatic - no camera changes** as the portable camera defaults. Under Setup's advanced camera settings, Direct V4L2 and low-latency exposure are optional measured choices. The Camera dropdown lists Automatic plus currently connected usable cameras and refreshes while Setup remains open. Keep Automatic when the camera may be added later; selecting a specific camera is useful mainly when more than one is present. Direct V4L2 falls back automatically when a camera cannot supply its required 640×480 MJPEG stream. With Direct V4L2 selected, Manual exposure and gain are also available. The Controller checks the attached camera's advertised controls, reports the values actually applied, and visibly falls back to automatic when manual control is unsupported. The tested Kiyo Pro setting is exposure **78**, gain **96**; do not assume those values fit another camera or room. Closing vision restores camera automation. These settings do not alter calibration or gesture thresholds.

Camera

Camera

Camera frame rate

Camera reader

Exposure behavior

Automatic — choose the connected

Automatic — prefer 30 fps

Compatible — OpenCV

Automatic — portable default

Hand or glove (diagnostic label)

Bare hand

Camera is delivering 30 fps. Reader: -; automatic fixed-rate exposure unavailable.

- Automatic is the best starting point and works when the camera is connected later.
- Direct V4L2 is the low-latency option and falls back safely when unsupported.
- Manual exposure is optional, camera-dependent, and restored to automatic when tracking closes.

[Open the Camera guide](#) for compatibility, exposure, lighting, and troubleshooting.

Save camera settings

Advanced camera settings with Automatic, a discovered camera, and optional manual exposure

3. Run the RetroPie installer

Run this single line in the RetroPie terminal:

```
SH
curl -fLO \
  https://github.com/mathan416/PowerGlove-Vision/releases/latest/download/install-retropie.sh \
  && bash install-retropie.sh
```

For a new installation, the script asks for your Controller hostname or IP address. There are no placeholders to replace in the command.

The script installs the receiver, controller mapping, game-launch integration, and automatic startup. Existing cabinet hooks and controller assignments remain. It offers missing emulator installation through RetroPie Setup and checks registered games, including Bad Street Brawler's Glove Zap configuration.

Follow any emulator or game ACTION messages. Missing games do not prevent the base installation. If asked to launch and exit FCEUmm once, do that and rerun the installer. If you use another emulator, the installer asks before selecting FCEUmm for Bad Street Brawler.

If a registered Super Glove Ball ROM is present, the installer also offers the optional [lr-nestopia-powerglove](#) core. Accepting installs Git and the standard build tools, downloads the pinned GPLv2 Nestopia source, applies the included patch, builds on that RetroPie, and registers a second emulator entry. It does not change the ROM's saved emulator: FCEUmm remains selected until you choose [lr-nestopia-powerglove](#) from RetroPie's per-ROM launch menu. Declining is safe and leaves the tested joystick fallback unchanged. The build needs internet access and may take several minutes; no ROM is read or copied by the build.

Checkpoint: The report confirms that receiver startup is configured. Pairing and live gameplay checks will still be listed as actions.

4. Pair the devices

The **Controller status** panel at the top of Setup shows the four Off-mode checks in pixel order: app, console service, authenticated response, and Networking. Green means confirmed, red means disconnected or not confirmed, and grey means unknown. Networking reflects a physical Wi-Fi or Ethernet link, including USB dock Ethernet; it is independent of the console checks. These checks do not prove that the game received input.

Both pairing methods below require the six-digit approval PIN shown on the Controller matrix and the certificate-ID comparison. The RetroPie one-time code or SSH password is an additional credential.

Pairing gives both devices the same private token. Use the recommended one-time-code method after both installers finish.

1. Open <https://UNO-Q-NAME.local:8443/setup>. Under **Connection and startup**, enter your console address and select **Save settings**. Pairing uses this saved address; unsaved edits must be saved first.
2. Under **Pair with RetroPie**, choose **One-time code (recommended)** and select **Continue**. Use **Change** beside the saved console to edit its address before starting.
3. In **Confirm your Controller**, compare the **ID** on the physical matrix with the beginning of the browser certificate's SHA-256 fingerprint. Expand **How to compare the certificate** for guidance. If they differ, stop pairing.
4. If they match, check the confirmation box, enter the six-digit **Controller approval PIN** shown after **PN** on the matrix, and select **Continue**.
5. On RetroPie, run `sudo /opt/powerglove/bin/powerglove-pair` and leave it running. Enter its 20-character code in **RetroPie one-time code**, then select **Pair with RetroPie**. This code is separate from the Controller approval PIN.
6. Selecting **Pair with RetroPie** brings **Pairing in progress** into view while the request runs, followed by **Pairing complete** or an error with retry instructions. On success, the receiver was restarted and answered an authenticated controller handshake using the newly installed token; you can open Dashboard when ready. On RetroPie, `sudo systemctl status powerglove-receiver.service` should report active. Pairing does not arm controller output or prove that a game received input.

The tested cabinet subsequently launched a game and responded to Controller input after this pairing flow, confirming the complete path in that installation. Repeat the game check after pairing a different system or changing its emulator configuration; the **Pairing complete** message itself remains a receiver-token check.

Pair with RetroPie

Pair this Controller with your saved RetroPie console. Both methods use a physical confirmation on the Controller matrix.

Saved console: RETROPIE-NAME.local [Change](#)

1. Choose a method

2. Confirm your Controller

3. Pair with RetroPie

1. Choose a pairing method

How will you connect?

☒ One-time code (recommended)
Run a command on RetroPie and enter the code it displays.

☐ SSH password
Use your RetroPie username and password. SSH password login must be enabled.

Continue

Guided pairing starts with the saved console and a choice of one-time code or SSH password.

Pair with RetroPie

Pair this Controller with your saved RetroPie console. Both methods use a physical confirmation on the Controller matrix.

Saved console: RETROPIE-NAME.local

1. Choose a method

2. Confirm your Controller

3. Pair with RetroPie

RETROPIE-NAME.local · One-time code

Confirmation window: 120 seconds remaining. Console and method are fixed until it ends.

2. Confirm your Controller

The Controller matrix shows ID 1234ABCD, then a six-digit approval PIN. Compare the browser certificate with the physical matrix before entering that PIN.

► How to compare the certificate

☒ I compared the browser certificate fingerprint with the matrix ID and they match
Controller approval PIN

Six digits shown on the Controller matrix

Continue

Controller confirmation with certificate comparison, matrix approval PIN, and remaining time.

Pair with RetroPie

Pair this Controller with your saved RetroPie console. Both methods use a physical confirmation on the Controller matrix.

Saved console: RETROPIE-NAME.local

1. Choose a method

2. Confirm your Controller

3. Pair with RetroPie

RETROPIE-NAME.local · One-time code · Controller confirmation entered

Pairing in progress

Sending the pairing request to RetroPie. Keep this page open while we wait for its response.

SSH pairing can take a few minutes. Pairing does not start controller output.

Pairing in progress. Waiting for RetroPie...

Pairing in progress while the request waits for RetroPie.

Pair with RetroPie

Pair this Controller with your saved RetroPie console. Both methods use a physical confirmation on the Controller matrix.

Saved console: RETROPIE-NAME.local [Change](#)

1. Choose a method

2. Confirm your Controller

3. Pair with RetroPie

RETROPIE-NAME.local · One-time code · Controller confirmation entered

Pairing complete

The RetroPie receiver was restarted. The matrix resumes its normal display; when idle, it follows your attract setting. Open Dashboard to start controller output when you are ready. Pairing does not verify that a game received input.

[Open Dashboard](#)

Pairing complete. The RetroPie receiver was restarted.

Pairing complete, with the next step on Dashboard.

The Controller confirmation window lasts two minutes. The console address and pairing method stay fixed during that window. If it expires, the PIN and password are cleared; select **Start a new confirmation**. You can change methods after the window ends. A submitted failure also requires fresh confirmation before retrying. Existing server PIN attempt limits still apply. If the window expires while you obtain a RetroPie code, repeat confirmation and obtain a new code if needed; neither credential has an unlimited lifetime.

Alternative: pair with your RetroPie password

Use this route only if RetroPie accepts SSH password login and your account can run `sudo` with that password.

1. Save the console address in **Connection and startup**.
2. In **Choose a pairing method**, select **SSH password**, then **Continue**.
3. Complete the same certificate comparison and Controller approval PIN step.
4. In **Pair with RetroPie**, enter your RetroPie username and password, then select **Pair with RetroPie**.
5. **Pairing in progress** stays visible while the request runs; SSH pairing can take a few minutes. Wait for **Pairing complete**, which includes an authenticated receiver-token check, then check the receiver service or open Dashboard. Errors are brought into view with retry instructions.

The password field is unavailable until certificate confirmation is complete. The password is used for pairing and is not saved by the Controller. Returning to **Review Controller confirmation**, a failure, expiry, or leaving the page clears it. If neither route works, use the [token-management reference](#).

When a submitted pairing attempt finishes, the matrix releases the approval PIN and resumes its normal display. When idle, the glove animation follows your On, Dim, or Off attract setting; active game and status displays still take priority.

Connection settings and recovery

Connection and startup saves the console address and startup game profile. Port, camera, and pairing-key replacement are under **Advanced connection settings**. **Check console address** only checks name resolution. If loading fails, use **Reload saved settings**; if a save fails, correct or retry it without losing fields. Controller Start/Stop and shutdown are on **Dashboard**; Setup keeps the read-only tracking and output status indicators.

Connection saves restart tracking. The separate **Save attract mode** action changes only the idle matrix display. Hand setup, players, and backups are in **Glove Academy**. Existing private settings and calibration remain preserved through the normal installation/upgrade process; the four-pixel display needs its matching matrix firmware. Extending the fourth pixel to Ethernet only needs the updated Controller app and host sampler. Normal installation and Wi-Fi deployment also install its unprivileged host status sampler. The receiver timeout correction takes effect after updating RetroPie as well as the Controller application.

5. Calibrate and test a game

1. On Dashboard, select a profile, wait for the camera, and show your hand. On first use, the app collects a neutral reference automatically. Use **Center hand** if your resting position produces unwanted movement or your camera/playing position changed. Hold a relaxed, open hand still at the intended center and distance until the button reports completion.
2. Select **Start controller**. This allows controller packets to reach RetroPie and creates the virtual input device.
3. On RetroPie, run `grep -A8 -B2 'PowerGlove Vision' /proc/bus/input/devices`. Look for the device name **PowerGlove Vision**. If it is missing, check pairing and the receiver service before changing emulator settings.
4. Use your physical controller to open RetroArch. Go to **Settings > Input > RetroPad Bindings > Port 1 Controls** and select **PowerGlove Vision**. Menu labels can vary with the RetroArch version.
5. Check the D-pad, A, B, Start, and Select assignments. The installer provides an automatic mapping; adjust bindings only if needed, then save the controller profile or RetroArch configuration.
6. Test movement and buttons in a game. If your cabinet merges multiple controllers, also configure that merger to accept the virtual device.

Checkpoint: A gesture changes the intended control in the running game. Seeing the device name or a running service alone is not an end-to-end test. Bad Street Brawler's Glove Zap uses simultaneous Left + Right through the standard gamepad path. The RetroPie installer checks the game-specific FCEUmm option. Follow any remaining ACTION message and rerun the installer after resolving it. See [Glove Zap setup](#). No extra-trigger assignment or receiver change is required.

A calibration uses 24 geometrically valid hand observations. MediaPipe's displayed score describes handedness certainty rather than position confidence, so it is not used as a false quality gate. Repeating calibration from the same position should give closely comparable center, scale, wrist, and jitter values, but natural landmark variation prevents an exact numeric match. Calibration is shared by every profile. Closing Dashboard after this check stops its 5 fps diagnostic preview work without stopping hand tracking or controller delivery.

For Super Glove Ball testing, enter RetroPie's launch menu while starting the ROM and choose either [lr-fceumm](#) or [lr-nestopia-powerglove](#). FCEUmm uses the ordinary D-pad and buttons for the whole session. The native core uses absolute X/Y/Z plus open-hand, fist, and index-point packets. Native movement uses **Latest coordinate** with MediaPipe Hands and the same saved center and reach. It validates the palm geometry and clamps it to that reach before mapping, so movement beyond an edge stays at the edge and a recovered hand normally starts from its first fresh coordinate. Latest holds only a contradictory or unusually distant non-forward reacquisition for one additional fresh result. Adjust native travel separately under **Glove Academy -> Tune gestures -> Movement reach**. Full-game cabinet play has confirmed grab/throw, index fire, and fist-plus-forward Power Punch. Continuous movement is playable, with further latency refinement still planned. Wrist rotation and remaining unused native packet fields stay neutral. Shared recognition remains available to every FCEUmm profile. A per-ROM selection is remembered, so choose FCEUmm again whenever you want the complete fallback.

Setup -> **Camera** offers Automatic, 30 fps, and 60 fps. Automatic is the 0.4.0 default: it tries the tested 30-fps path and then accepts the camera driver's usable rate if necessary. The active rate is shown while tracking runs. Other UVC cameras do not need to support both explicit rates. See the [Camera guide](#) before changing the reader, exposure, or gain. Dashboard's optional **Show statistics** switch is off by default; leave it off for the lightest gameplay page and enable it only when reading diagnostics.

6. Confirm startup and finish

- Launch a registered game and check the expected profile on Dashboard and the matrix.
- Exit the game and confirm that gestures turn off.
- Reboot both devices normally. Confirm that Dashboard returns and the matrix progresses through startup to the selected mode. The early-start helper is enabled automatically for this boot.
- Check that your saved tuning and calibration remain available.
- Select **Start controller** when ready and verify movement and buttons in the game.

The installers never reboot or request a shutdown automatically. They check that the Controller shutdown helper is ready. The tested Arduino UNO Q hardware restarts after a halt; a disconnected website or blank matrix is not proof that power can be removed.

Updates and checks

Updates keep an inventory of installed application files. After the first inventory is created, unchanged obsolete files are backed up and removed; your own changes are kept and reported. If an update is interrupted, follow its recovery instructions before trying again.

To update, repeat the same single-line commands on both machines. Each selects the latest published stable release. Changed managed files are backed up, and the installer prints their location. It asks before interrupting an active Controller session. Close RetroArch before updating RetroPie. [config/profiles.json](#) is intentionally replaced; saved personal tuning remains in [data/gesture-tuning.json](#).

For checks only, use the script you already downloaded:

```
SH
# On the PowerGlove Vision Controller:
bash install-uno-q.sh --check
# On RetroPie:
bash install-retropie.sh --check
```

Checks do not download, install, restart, or change anything. They may request sudo access to inspect protected settings.

Report	Meaning
PASS	The named check succeeded.
FAIL	Resolve the problem before proceeding, then rerun the installer or checks.
ACTION	Complete the named step, such as pairing, adding games, or checking gameplay.

A successful technical installation can still report ACTION for the physical checks. Those checks need you and your cabinet.

If movement feels delayed after installation, use the [read-only latency baseline](#) before changing sensitivity or video settings. It separates Controller timing from the receiver, emulator, and display checks and does not enable controls.

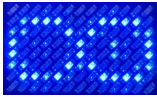
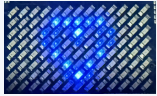
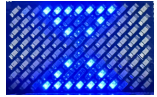
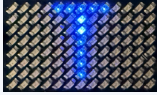
For a specific version or a development prerelease, use the [technical installation reference](#). It also explains compatibility, package building, backups, and recovery.

If something does not work

- **Download fails:** confirm that the latest stable release includes installer assets, check internet access, and retry. A failed verification installs nothing.
- **Unsupported board software:** complete App Lab provisioning or use a compatible project release. Do not bypass the installer's compatibility check.
- **Website does not open:** try the Controller's current IP address instead of its hostname. Use HTTP on port 8088 and HTTPS on port 8443.
- **Camera missing:** open Glove Academy and wait for the camera view. The Controller host helper automatically enrolls the single UVC camera and its parent hub on first successful use, even if no camera was connected during installation. After enrollment it makes one guarded reset attempt during a sustained outage. If it remains missing, reconnect or power-cycle the camera and check the powered hub and cable; USB Ethernet may briefly disconnect during recovery.
- **No controller in RetroArch:** finish pairing, select Start controller, and select PowerGlove Vision for Port 1 using your physical controller.
- **Partial installation:** correct the reported problem and rerun the same release. Keep the printed backup location for recovery.

For diagnostic commands or manual repair, use the [configuration reference](#).

Read the matrix and open the web pages

Display	See it	Meaning
Arduino boot logo		System startup, before the app display.
System heart		System startup is progressing.
Pulsing hourglass		PowerGlove Vision is starting.
Lightning and animated glove		Gestures are off. The revised animation requires updated matrix firmware.
Scanning L		Play or Glove Academy practice is active; controller output is paused.
Scanning T		Tune gestures is active; controller output is paused.
A-I		The corresponding profile is selected; Program A is shown.
BS		Bad Street Brawler is selected.
GB		Super Glove Ball is selected.
Blank matrix		No LEDs are illuminated. Check board power and Dashboard; blank does not confirm shutdown.
Pulsing profile code		A calibrated hand is being tracked. Confirm controller output separately.
Blinking X		The app has requested an error display. Check Dashboard for the cause.

See the [Matrix display guide](#) for the complete animations and startup sequence. An animation does not prove that shutdown has finished.

Page	Address
Dashboard	http://UNO-Q-NAME.local:8088/dashboard
Play	http://UNO-Q-NAME.local:8088/play
Glove Academy	http://UNO-Q-NAME.local:8088/learn
Games (lower Setup section)	http://UNO-Q-NAME.local:8088/setup#games-section
Help and printable manuals	http://UNO-Q-NAME.local:8088/help
Connection settings	http://UNO-Q-NAME.local:8088/setup
Secure pairing	https://UNO-Q-NAME.local:8443/setup

Add and manage players in **Setup -> Players**. Choose the active player on Dashboard or in Glove Academy before practicing or playing. Progress and hand sensitivity persist across restarts and normal upgrades. Selecting a player immediately loads their sensitivity, progress, and saved center. Use **Center hand** for a new player or after moving the camera or changing playing position. Restoring a hand-setup backup requires centering unless you explicitly reuse its calibration with the same camera and playing positions. Backups include name, personal and effective sensitivity, source software identity, and calibration. Version-2 is the first supported portable format; version-1 sensitivity-only files are rejected. The web footer reports exact software and running firmware identities; older firmware may report unavailable.

Choose each player in turn and select **Back up hand setup** to download a separate file named for that player, such as [iain-powerglove-hand-setup.json](#). Your browser saves it on the computer, phone, or tablet you are using, usually in **Downloads** or the folder you choose. To restore, select the player you want to update, choose **Restore hand setup**, and pick that player's saved file from your device. Review it before confirming; restore updates the selected player, rather than adding a new one.

Completing all sixteen lessons replaces the lesson panel with the **Glove Master** award. **Start again** restores the lessons.

Setup

Connect RetroPie, manage players, and choose how the camera and controls behave. For gesture practice and centering, open [Glove Academy](#). For a guided walkthrough, see [Installation and setup](#).



Controller status

1 • Controller app
Running

2 • Console service
Reachable

3 • Authenticated response
Confirmed

4 • Networking
Connected

Tracking
Idle

Controller output
Stopped

Saved console: RETROPIE-NAME.local

Console checked 1 seconds ago. These checks do not confirm that a game received input.

Players

Active player

Iain

Player settings loaded.

► Players and hand-setup backups

Matrix attract mode

Idle display

On — full animation

Setup connection settings and pairing; use HTTPS to enable pairing

Help serves the public manuals, illustrations, and PDFs locally. **This console** shows addresses derived from your current browser connection and public device settings. It never displays the token. The standalone Quick Reference is excluded from the public package; the live cabinet page supplies local details.

Play Checklist

1. Power the RetroPie and PowerGlove Vision Controller; leave the camera connected to the powered hub.
2. Open <http://UNO-Q-NAME.local:8088/dashboard>.
3. Select the active profile on the Dashboard, then confirm the expected profile and a detected hand. The saved startup profile remains on Setup.
4. On first use, or after changing your camera or playing position, select **Center hand** while holding a comfortable neutral pose. Otherwise reuse the saved calibration.
5. Select **Start controller** when you are ready to arm gesture control.
6. Launch a registered game and confirm its profile code on the matrix. Delivery begins only after RetroArch is running and its short initialization guard ends.
7. Select **Stop controller** before adjusting the camera or leaving the cabinet.
8. Read the shutdown limitation before disconnecting power. **Shutdown** requests a graceful halt, but the tested board restarts; an offline website is not proof that it is safe to unplug.

PowerGlove Vision remembers the player's explicit **Start controller** or **Stop controller** choice across Controller application and system restarts. A remembered Start means **armed**, not unconditional output: controls are sent only during a live registered RetroArch session or after an intentional manual Dashboard profile selection. A registered game renews its session while RetroArch is running, so an Controller application restart can reconnect automatically. Game exit, an unknown game, or an expired session releases all controls and stops delivery without changing the armed preference. **Stop controller** remains sticky until explicitly started again. Install the same release on both devices because this behavior uses a matching Controller worker and RetroPie launch hook.

Vision and the dashboard keep running while output is unarmed or waiting for a game, so setup never generates surprise game inputs. **Shutdown** is different: it halts Linux on the Controller. The tested board automatically restarts; remaining halted is not guaranteed.

Optional latency diagnostics

Normal installation leaves timing traces off and does not install or select the separate diagnostic core. The [native test procedure](#) explains temporary process environments, same-architecture diagnostic builds, private local evidence, and restoration of the normal launch configuration. Video analysis dependencies belong in a temporary Mac environment. Capture the physical hand and cabinet screen together; deployment alone is not a latency test.

For a guided symptom check, see [Troubleshooting by symptom](#).